

TAG QUESTIONS

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PALA

YOUR VISION; OUR MISSION

TAG QUESTIONS. For What?

1. We use tag questions to confirm or check information or ask for agreement.

- You want to come with me, **don't you?**
- Tom can swim, **can't he?**
- You don't know where the boss is, **do you?**
- You know where the boss is, **don't you?**
- This meal is horrible, **isn't it?**
- That film was fantastic, **wasn't it?**

TAG QUESTIONS. For What?

2. We use tag questions to check whether something is true.

- The meeting's tomorrow at 9 a. m., **isn't it?**
- You won't go without me, **will you?**

RULE 1

- If the main clause is NEGATIVE, the Question Tag starts with the relevant positive **Auxiliary**. If there is **no auxiliary**, use **Do/Does/Did**.

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- He **is not** coming, **IS** he?
- He **cannot** do it, **CAN** he?
- He **won't** come, **WILL** he?

Remember!

- Give = Do + Give
- Gives = Does + Give
- Gave = Did + Give

RULE 1

- If the main clause is **NEGATIVE**, the Question Tag starts with the relevant positive **Auxiliary**. If there is **no auxiliary**, use **Do/Does/Did**.

- He **is not** coming, **IS** he?
- He **cannot** do it, **CAN** he?
- He **won't** come, **WILL** he?

- They **do not/don't** study, **DO** they?
- He **does not/doesn't** study, **DOES** he?
- He **did not/didn't** come, **DID** he?

RULE 2

- If the main clause is POSITIVE, the Question Tag starts with the CONTRACTED NEGATIVE form of the relevant **Auxiliary** or **Do/Does/Did**.

Negatives

Positive		Negative	
<u>long form</u>	<u>short form</u>	<u>long form</u>	<u>short form</u>
Can	--	cannot	can't
Could	--	could not	couldn't
May	--	may not	--
Might	--	might not	mightn't
ought to	--	ought not to	oughtn't to
should	'd	should not	shouldn't
Will	'll	will not	won't
Would	'd	would not	wouldn't



RULE 2

- If the main clause is POSITIVE, the Question Tag starts with the CONTRACTED NEGATIVE form of the relevant **Auxiliary** or **Do/Does/Did**.
- He **is** coming, **ISN'T** he?
- He **can** do it, **CAN'T** he?
- He **will** come, **WON'T** he?
- They **study** hard, **DON'T** they?
- He **studies** hard, **DOESN'T** he?
- He **studied** hard, **DIDN'T** he?

RULE 3

In an affirmative statement, if the auxiliary is **'am'** the auxiliary changes to *aren't* in the tag.

- I am sitting next to you, **aren't I?**
- (ain't, amn't) **X**
- I'm a little red, **aren't I?**
- **I am not invited, am I?**

RULE 4 - a

With *let's*, the tag is *shall we?*

- Let's go to the beach, **shall we?**
- Let's have a cup of coffee, **shall we?**

- Let's go to the beach, **shall we?**

BUT

- **Let us** go to the beach, **will you?**

RULE 4 - b

With *let's not also*, the tag is *shall we?*

- Let's not go to the beach, shall we?
- Let's not bother him, shall we?

RULE 5-a

With an imperative (positive or negative), the tag is *will you?*

- Close the window, **will you?**
- Hold this, **will you?**
- Don't drink cold water, **will you?**
- Drink water, **will you?**

RULE 5-b

(BBC)

Imperatives don't have a tense or use an auxiliary verb in the same way as other sentences do. To make a question tag with imperatives, we use **won't you?** although other modal verbs can be used, such as **will, would, can, and could.**

Sit down, won't you?

Open the window, would you?

Don't go outside, will you?

Keep quiet, won't you?

RULE 5-c

(BBC)

Politeness and formality depend upon the choice of question tag and the tone of your voice, although **can't you** can come across as quite impatient and annoyed:

Turn the TV down, can't you?

RULE 6

- If the main clause is NEGATIVE, the Question Tag starts with the relevant positive **Auxiliary**.

NEGATIVES

Not, no, never, nothing, no one, nobody, none,
neither;

Barely, hardly, scarcely, rarely, seldom, few, little

RULE 6-a

If the subject is *nobody, somebody, none, everybody, no one, someone* or *everyone*, we use “**they**” in the tag.

- Nobody asked for me, **did they?**
- Nobody **lives** here, **do they?**
- Someone will help, **won't they?**
- Nobody will help, **will they?**

RULE 6-b

We use an affirmative tag after a sentence containing a negative word such as *never, hardly, nobody etc.*

Nobody, somebody etc. are '*they*' in the tag. And the *accompanying auxiliary* will be *plural*.

- Nobody lives in this house, **do they?**
- You've (You have) never liked me, **have you?**

RULE 7

When the subject is *nothing*, we use “**it**” in the tag.

- **Nothing** bad happened, **did it?**
- **Nothing** ever happens here, **does it?**

RULE 8

Use “**there**” in a question tag when the sentences include “**there** + a form of **be**”.

- **There** is a lot of work to do today, isn't **there**?

RULE 8

This/That = it

These/Those = they

This/That is a great choice,?

This/That is a great choice, isn't it?

These/Those are your friends,?

These/Those are your friends, aren't they?

RULE 9

- You have a Ferrari, **you?**

RULE 9

- You have a Ferrari, **don't you?**

RULE 9

- You have bought a Ferrari, **you?**

RULE 9

- You have bought a Ferrari, **haven't you?**

RULE 9

If the main verb in the sentence is *have* (not an auxiliary verb), use *do* in the tag.

- You have a Ferrari, **don't you?**
- You have a Ferrari, **haven't you? X**

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If the main verb in the sentence is *have* (not an auxiliary verb), use *do* in the tag.

- You have a Ferrari, **don't you?**
- You have a Ferrari, **haven't you?** **X**
- She had a great time,she?

RULE 9

If the main verb in the sentence is *have* (not an auxiliary verb), use *do* in the tag.

- You have a Ferrari, **don't you?**
- You have a Ferrari, **haven't you?** **X**
- She had a great time, **didn't she?**

RULE 9

If the main verb in the sentence is *have* (not an auxiliary verb), use *do* in the tag.

- You have a Ferrari, **don't you?**
- You have a Ferrari, **haven't you?** **X**
- She had a great time, **didn't she?**
- She had had a great career, she?

RULE 9

If the main verb in the sentence is *have* (not an auxiliary verb), use *do* in the tag.

- You have a Ferrari, **don't you?**
- You have a Ferrari, **haven't you?** **X**
- She had a great time, **didn't she?**
- She had had a great career, **hadn't she?**

RULE 10

With *used to*, we use “**didn’t**” in the tag

- You used to work here, **didn’t you?**
- He used to have long hair, **didn’t he?**
- We used to protest, **didn’t we?**

BUT

- We **are** used to protests, **aren’t we?**

RULE 11

We **can use affirmative tags after affirmative sentences** to express a reaction such as surprise or interest. We are not asking a question or looking for confirmation; we are simply repeating information.

- You're going to Japan, **are you?**

RULE 11

We **can use affirmative tags after affirmative sentences** to express a reaction such as surprise or interest. We are not asking a question or looking for confirmation, we are simply repeating information.

- David is your boyfriend, **isn't he?** ↗ (I think he is, but I'm not sure)
- Oh yes, he's my boyfriend
- David is your boyfriend, **is he?** ↘ (I know perfectly well, I just want to let you know that I know)
- Well, yes. Who told you?
- Oh, everybody knows now

RULE 11

We **can use affirmative tags after affirmative sentences** to express a reaction such as surprise or interest. We are not asking a question or looking for confirmation, we are simply repeating information.

- Hello, I'm Tom. I will be your student this year.
- Oh, so you will be my student, will you?
- Yes, nice to meet you, sir.

RULE 11

We **can use affirmative tags after affirmative sentences** to express a reaction such as surprise or interest. We are not asking a question or looking for confirmation, we are simply repeating information.

- Mary will come later, will she?
- You're Tommy Cherian, are you?
- Oh, so this is your house, is it?
- So you're having a baby soon, are you?

Congratulations!

- Your father is at home, is he? Can I come in?

RULE 11

We **can use affirmative tags after affirmative sentences** to express a reaction such as surprise or interest. We are not asking a question or looking for confirmation, we are simply repeating information.

- You're going to Japan, **are you?** (100 % Going)
- You're going to Japan, **aren't you?** (80% Going)
- You're not going to Japan, **are you?** (80% Not going)

RULE 12

If you start a sentence with **I think**, don't use the question tag **do/don't I**. Make the question tag agree with the main information in the sentence. This does not apply in the second or third person.

I think it's a nice day, isn't it?

I don't think that's a good idea, is it?

You thought you'd be OK, **didn't you?** (second person)

He thinks he's going to win, **doesn't he?** (third person)

Let's See!

- Sherli cannot be trusted,?
- Sherli cannot be trusted, can she?
- I am a little late,?
- I am a little late, aren't I?
- I am not late,?
- I am not late, am I?

Let's See!

- There will be no class tomorrow,?
- There will be no class tomorrow, will there?
- He has gone there,?
- He has gone there, hasn't he?
- You have two brothers,?
- You have two brothers, don't you?

Let's See!

- The cat is sleeping,?
- The cat is sleeping, isn't it?
- They may come,?
- They may come, ~~mayn't~~/mightn't they?
- None of the boys are sincere,?
- None of the boys are sincere, are they?

Let's See!

- This/That is a good car,?
- This/That is a good car, isn't it?
- These/Those are good cars,?
- These/Those are good cars, aren't they?
- I shouldn't have gone there,?
- I shouldn't have gone there, should I?

Let's See!

- He has no sisters,?
- He has no sisters, does he?
- She will never trust you,?
- She will never trust you, will she?
- Rahul hardly knows her,?
- Rahul hardly knows her, does he?

Let's See!

- Don't forget to post the letter,?
- Don't forget to post the letter, will you?
- Let's go to the cinema today,?
- Let's go to the cinema today, shall we?
- Please let us see the manager,?
- Please let us see the manager, will you?

Let's See!

- Nobody called me, ?
- Nobody called me, did they?
- I am not too serious,?
- I am not too serious, am I?
- I am too impatient,?
- I am too impatient, aren't I?

Let's See!

- Everyone was ready to help her,?
- Everyone was ready to help her, weren't they?
- Someone gave you the information,?
- Someone gave you the information, didn't they?
- Have another piece of cake,?
- Have another piece of cake, will you?
- He has no sisters,?
- He has no sisters, does he?

Let's See!

- *Your mum **hadn't** met him before,?*
- *Your mum **hadn't** met him before, **had** she?*
- ***None** of those customers **were** happy,?*
- ***None** of those customers **were** happy, **were** they?*
- *Jenni **eats** cheese,?*
- *Jenni **eats** cheese, **doesn't** she?*
- *I **said** that already,?*
- *I **said** that already, **didn't** I?*

Let's See!

- *I'm never on time,?*
- *I'm never on time, **am I?***
- *I'm going to get an email,?*
- *I'm going to get an email, **aren't I?***
- *There has been little rain in this area for too long,.....?*
- *There has been little rain in this area for too long, **has there?***

Let's See!

- *They used to live in New Orleans,?*
- *They used to live in New Orleans, didn't they?*
- *Don't talk to Peter during the lesson,?*
- *Don't talk to Peter during the lesson, will you?*
- *Discuss with Peter during the lesson,?*
- *Discuss with Peter during the lesson, will you?*
- *I think he's from India,?*
- *I think he's from India, isn't he?*
- *Let's go swimming,?*
- *Let's go swimming, shall we?*

Let's See!

1. I really like action movies, but you can't stand them,.....

a. don't I?

b. can you?

c. can't I?

d. do you?

Let's See!

1. I really like action movies, but you can't stand them,.....

a. don't I?

b. can you?

c. can't I?

d. do you?

Let's See!

2. If you can't access your account, you have to call the service centre,.....

- a. can you?
- b. can't you?
- c. have you?
- d. don't you?

Let's See!

2. If you can't access your account, you have to call the service centre,.....

- a. can you?
- b. can't you?
- c. have you?
- d. don't you?

Let's See!

3. We gave them the money yesterday, but we haven't received a receipt yet,.....

- a. didn't we?
- b. didn't they?
- c. haven't we?
- d. have we?

Let's See!

3. We gave them the money yesterday, but we haven't received a receipt yet,.....

- a. didn't we?
- b. didn't they?
- c. haven't we?
- d. have we?

Let's See!

4. Foreign travel is very exciting, but it can be quite expensive,.....

- a. can it?
- b. can't it?
- c. isn't it?
- d. is it?

Let's See!

4. Foreign travel is very exciting, but it can be quite expensive,.....

- a. can it?
- b. can't it?**
- c. isn't it?
- d. is it?

Let's See!

5. If you don't like your job, you should look for another one,.....

- a. shouldn't you?
- b. should you?
- c. don't you?
- d. shouldn't it?

Let's See!

5. If you don't like your job, you should look for another one,.....

a. shouldn't you?

b. should you?

c. don't you?

d. shouldn't it?

Let's See!

**6. You can't afford to buy the shoes I showed
you,.....**

- a. can you?
- b. did you?
- c. can't I?
- d. didn't I?

Let's See!

6. You can't afford to buy the shoes I showed you,.....

a. can you?

b. did you?

c. can't I?

d. didn't I?

-
1. You've called the children,
2. They're coming tomorrow,
3. This isn't going to be cheap,
4. You haven't finished packing,
5. We don't need any more boxes,
6. Pablo is going to help us,
7. We can put some things in this basket,
8. Jack isn't buying our bookcases,
9. We need to disconnect the phone,
10. The salesmen aren't packing the books for us,
11. We can't turn off the electricity yet,
12. Karol is sick,
- a. can we?
b. do we?
c. is he?
d. isn't she?
e. aren't they?
f. have you?
g. isn't he?
h. is it?
i. haven't you?
j. don't we?
k. can't we?
l. are they?
- Connections:
1 → f
2 → l
3 → b
4 → e
5 → a
6 → h
7 → g
8 → c
9 → j
10 → k
11 → d
12 → i

Don't forget!!!

- I am very tired, aren't I?
- Close the door, will you?
- Don't go there, will you?
- Let's dance, shall we?